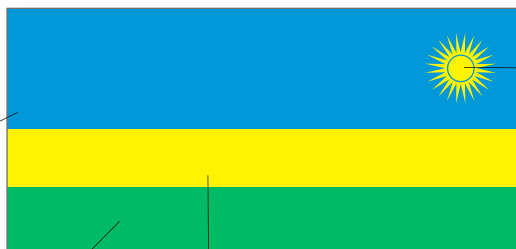


Rwanda

Ratio: 6:13 **Adopted:** December 31, 2001 **Usage:** National and Civil

*Light blue
stands for
the hope of
happiness
and peace*



*The Golden Sun
symbolizes the
enlightenment
that will bring
unity and fight
ignorance*

*Green represents
future prosperity*

*Yellow is symbolic of the need for
economic growth*

Africa



Rwanda, originally part of German East Africa, was taken over by Belgium after the First World War. It became independent on July 1, 1962.

In 2001 Rwanda adopted a new national flag, national arms and a national anthem, in response to the government's desire to concentrate on future possibilities rather than the troubled past. It was decided that the old national symbols reinforced the ideas of ethnic separatism and violence which eventually led to the genocide of 1994. For the new flag,

red and black, which have often been associated with blood and mourning respectively, were removed, in favor of the more optimistic blue, yellow, and green. The new national symbols of Rwanda signify national unity, respect for work, patriotism, and confidence in the future.

ARMS OF RWANDA

*The arms show
a traditional hut,
defended by shields*



*Emblems of agriculture
and industry*

*The motto is:
"Unity, Work,
Patriotism"*

*All surrounded by a
rope to show unity*